



(1) Data derived from S&P Capital IQ as of August 31, 2025. See page 41 for more details on Houlihan Lokey's Digital Assets Public Index composition and performance.

Houlihan Lokey's Digital Assets Public Index has outperformed the S&P 500 year-to-date by +9%, reflecting renewed investor confidence in well-capitalized, regulatory-forward players.

(1) See page 41 for more details on Houlihan Lokey's Digital Assets Public Index composition and performance.





- [Index Performance](#)
- [Public Company Trading Detail](#)

- [Houlihan Lokey Platform Overview](#)
- [Additional Coverage Reports](#)
- [Relevant Transaction Case Study](#)
- [Glossary of Key Terms](#)





Ozzie Ozdemir
Vice President
Portfolio Valuation
London



Milko Pavlov
Managing Director
Portfolio Valuation
London



Jeff Tarbell
Director
Estate Valuation
San Francisco



John Hartigan
Senior Vice President
New York



Rijul Malik
Associate
Minneapolis



response
Tokenized Energy or
Carbon Credits

Staking Commissions

Security Audits and
Consulting

Integration/Compliance-as-
a-Service
Capital Gains and Inflation
Hedge

Subscriptions



- Brokerage, Trading, and Market Making
- Indexing and Data/Analytics
- Bitcoin-as-Measure
- Trade Finance
- Programmable Money
- Banks and Custody
- Interoperability
- Asset Security
- Compliance Tooling
- NFTs
- Enterprise Technology (Apps and Infrastructure)
- Mining
- Compute

Tombstones included herein represent transactions closed from 2020 forward.



Update, and stablecom Overview

02



(1) *Wall Street Journal, The Daily Upside.*



On-Chain Projects Are Merging to Simplify Governance, Align Incentives, and Unlock Institutional Access

and tokenization platforms with enterprise-grade compliance. Plug-and-play infrastructure is attracting both strategics and sponsors.

Sources: PitchBook, company filings, company websites, Chainalysis, press releases.
(1) Includes M&A and capital raises.

Mar-21



M&A

~\$200



Counterparty Risk

High

Medium

Smart Contract Risk



Enterprise BTC adoption is increasing demand for secure custody, on-chain accounting, and treasury tooling—opening up inorganic growth paths for infrastructure vendors and digital finance platforms.



Sources: Press releases, BitBIO, S&P Capital IQ; market data as of August 31, 2025.



Strategy⁸

August 2020

Strategy (formerly MicroStrategy) began accumulating Bitcoin in August 2020, positioning it as a core treasury asset and continuing to scale its holdings through equity and debt financing. It now holds roughly 3% of total BTC supply.

embed jurisdiction-specific KYC/AML, token classification, and reporting directly into the infrastructure stack and are not bolted on post-launch.

Sources: PitchBook, company filings, company websites, Chainalysis, press releases.
(1) Includes M&A and capital raises.

May-23	metaco		M&A	\$250
Feb-23	GK8		M&A	\$44



Sources: Press releases, Galaxy Research, CB Insights, Binance Institutional, Fireblocks, relevant news articles; market data as of August 31, 2025.



regionally licensed entities to accelerate market entry and global product expansion while building vertically integrated platforms across custody, clearing, and execution.

Nov-24			M&A	--
Nov-21			M&A	--

-  AU, EU, U.K., U.S.
-  CA, U.S., EU
-  EU, U.K., CH
-  AU, BH, EU, SG, SK, U.K., U.S.



 / 
 June 2025
 February 2019

Robinhood to expand its crypto business beyond the U.S. market.
 The acquisition allowed Kraken to expand its European infrastructure (futures, indices) and bolstered its FCA-compliant operations.

Sources: Messari, press releases, PitchBook; market data as of August 31, 2025.
Notes: Deal count and value based on public M&A disclosures and PitchBook data. Coinbase has been actively working in Brazil to establish a regulatory framework but has not yet been finalized as of August 2025; Coinbase currently operates in Brazil with basic exchange services for retail customers.

As Bitcoin moves toward a store-of-value role, miners are investing in infrastructure aligned with Layer 2 scaling and payment use cases, consolidating to influence future network economics and utility layers.

Sources: PitchBook, company filings, company websites, Chainalysis, press releases.
(1) Includes M&A and capital raises.

Oct-24



CleanSpark ⚡

M&A

\$155

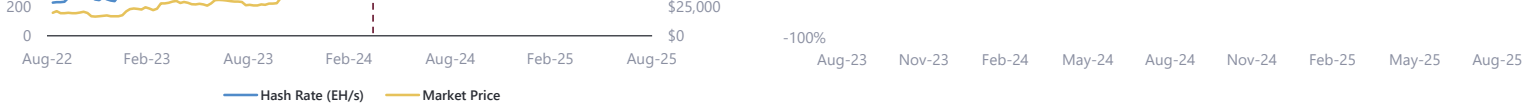
Sep-24

**Bitcoin Mining Facilities
and Land in Tennessee**

CleanSpark ⚡

Corporate Asset
Purchase

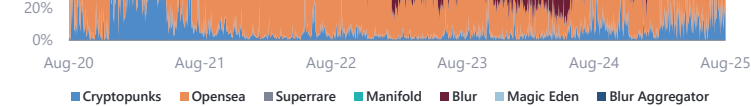
\$28



Mergers can streamline token structures and improve protocol clarity, making it easier to interface with centralized exchanges, custodians, and institutional allocators.

Sources: PitchBook, company filings, company websites, Chainalysis, press releases.
(1) Includes M&A and capital raises.

Feb-22	 dharma	 OpenSea	M&A	--
Dec-21	 Mir Protocol	 polygon	M&A	\$400



Sources: Press releases, The Block, DefiLlama; market data as of August 31, 2025.
Note: TTM as of August 2025.

(1) RWA TVL (real-world asset total value locked) measures the total dollar value of real-world financial assets—like U.S. treasuries, private credit, and real estate—that have been tokenized and locked into blockchain protocols or platforms.





environment for MNCs. Meanwhile, incentives in hubs such as the UAE, Qatar, and Hong Kong attract acquirers targeting global expansion.



Areas such as DePIN and tokenized assets are specifically highlighted as requiring customized regulatory frameworks to support innovation and growth.



While the Act enhances market integrity through increased disclosures and oversight, it also introduces operational burdens that may reshape industry dynamics, favoring well-capitalized players and raising barriers for smaller innovators.

Private Market Transformation

Tokenization boosts efficiency in private assets by improving liquidity, price discovery, and portfolio construction, while reducing friction and settlement risk.

Market Protections

- agencies like the CFPB and FTC.
- **Jurisdictional Restrictions:** Foreign issuers from sanctioned or high-risk jurisdictions are prohibited from operating in U.S. markets.

- Market consolidation, as smaller issuers face rising compliance costs and foreign platforms adapt to U.S. regulatory standards.

compliance, and investor protection.

- Ongoing regulatory adaptation in response to innovation, risk, and feedback.



While MiCA brings legal clarity and credibility to the digital assets sector, it also raises compliance costs—posing challenges for startups and smaller players. Still, it is seen as a foundational step toward integrating digital assets into mainstream finance and positioning the EU as a global leader.

compliance costs may deter startups or push them abroad—potentially impacting Europe's blockchain competitiveness.

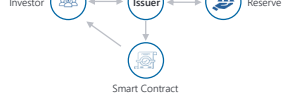
regulators plan to address these gaps in future updates, aiming to keep the framework adaptable as the blockchain space evolves.



in the coming years.

”





Source: Blocktrade.

Web3 and Programmable Money

- Payment rails for NFTs and on-chain commerce.
- Micropayments, tipping, and creator monetization.
- DAOs and protocol treasuries using stablecoins for budgeting, grants, and payroll.

2017 2018 2019 2020 2021 2022 2023 2024 2025 YTD

Digital Assets Trading Volume Total Stablecoin Active Addresses



Sources: U.S. Treasury, Citi Institute, Tagus Capital, DefiLlama.

Note: Data derived from Artemis, Citi Institute, and The Block as of August 31, 2025.

(1) Per Citi Institute estimate ("Digital Dollars," 2025).

and cyclical considerations.

Beyond macro dynamics, the rapid scaling of USD stablecoins in emerging markets and beyond may also prompt policy responses from governments seeking to preserve monetary autonomy.

Stripe acquired Bridge, deepening a prior partnership that enabled USDC payouts on Solana, Ethereum, and Polygon. The acquisition strengthens Stripe's stablecoin infrastructure, allowing platforms and marketplaces to send fast, low-cost global payouts using USDC.

for a regulatory framework that preserves blockchain's core benefits while addressing its unique challenges—framing this not just as a digital asset innovation, but as the future of capital markets.

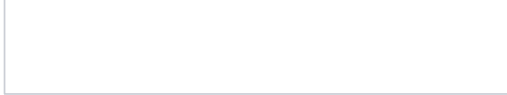
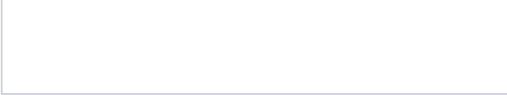




Payments, Treasury, and Custody



Note: Market map lists are meant to be representative and not exhaustive.

















Notes: Indices shown are equal-weighted with all share prices rebased to 100. Data derived from S&P Capital IQ as of August 31, 2025.

(1) Houlihan Lokey Digital Assets Index includes all companies depicted in the Diversified Digital Assets and Energy/Power Infrastructure groupings.

(2) The Nasdaq Crypto™ Index (NCI™) is a dynamic benchmark designed to track the performance of the digital assets market, representing a broad range of cryptocurrencies.



Notes: Analysis and trading multiples are based on share price, other market data, and broker consensus future-earnings estimates from S&P Capital IQ as of August 31, 2025.

Rule of 40 calculated as % Revenue Growth plus % (EBITDA—CapEx) Margin.

"n.a." designates outlier multiple greater than 40.0x or a negative figure.

LTM figures are used if the 2025 estimate is not available.



Investors, Acquirers, and Transactions

05

010.1

Sources: PitchBook, company filings, company websites, Chainalysis, press releases.
Note: Selected, nonexhaustive acquisitions depicted from January 2021 to August 2025.

Ownership: Consortium



Ownership:



[STO:CS](#)



2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025 YTD	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025 YTD
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Source: PitchBook (latest Digital Assets reporting as of August 31, 2025).
Notes: Completed deals only. Data is nonexhaustive but highly representative of market trends.

Sources: PitchBook, S&P Capital IQ, Mergermarket.com, other publicly available company filings, and industry news reports.
Note: Deals are listed chronologically based on transaction announcement.

392	349			330	339	460							
2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025 YTD	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025 YTD

Source: PitchBook (latest Digital Assets reporting as of August 31, 2025).
 Notes: Completed deals only. Data is nonexhaustive but highly representative of market trends.

Sources: PitchBook, S&P Capital IQ, Mergermarket.com, other publicly available company filings, and industry news reports.
Note: Deals are listed chronologically based on transaction announcement.





Leading

Capital Solutions Group

(1) As of August 29, 2025.
(2) LTM ended June 30, 2025.

50



Houlihan Lokey

1,800+

Transactions Completed Valued at
More Than **\$3.8 Trillion** Collectively

2,000+

Annual Valuation Engagements

1,900+

Sponsors Covered Globally

September 18, 2025
Boston, MA

October 26–29, 2025
Las Vegas, NV

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November 18–20, 2025
London, United Kingdom

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oversee the fund administration business while also serving in a strategic visionary role.

Sources: Press releases.

Note: The featured transaction closed on April 22, 2022.





Layer 2 (L2)	Scalability solutions built on top of L1 blockchains to increase throughput and reduce transaction costs (e.g., Arbitrum, Optimism, zkSync).
Markets in Crypto-Assets Regulation (MiCA)	A comprehensive regulatory framework adopted by the EU to govern crypto-asset markets, issuers, and service providers.

Total Value Locked (TVL)	A metric used to measure the total capital deposited in a DeFi protocol, often used as a proxy for platform usage and trust.
Web3	A decentralized internet paradigm where users control their own data and identity enabled by blockchain, smart contracts, and token-based incentives.







